

Contractions and Possessive Nouns

USA Grade 2 ELA
CCSS L.2.2.C

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING TARGET

I can use apostrophes in contractions and frequently occurring possessive nouns.

KEY STRATEGY + WORKED EXAMPLE

In a contraction, the apostrophe replaces missing letters. In a possessive noun, it shows ownership.

do not -> don't; the dog's bowl belongs to the dog.

A. TRY TOGETHER - USE THE STRATEGY

1. cannot = ____
2. I am = ____
3. the hat of Mia = ____ hat
4. the tail of the cat = ____ tail

B. CORE PRACTICE - READ AND WRITE

5. we are = ____

7. did not = ____

9. Possessive: Ben book = ____

11. Choose: dogs/dog's leash

6. they will = ____

8. she is = ____

10. Possessive: bird nest = ____

12. Choose: cant/can't wait

C. INDEPENDENT PRACTICE - APPLY THE PATTERN

13. you are = ____

15. was not = ____

17. Possessive: teacher desk = ____

19. Use we're in a sentence.

14. it is = ____

16. will not = ____

18. Possessive: baby toy = ____

20. Use girl's in a sentence.

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D. APPLY THE SKILL IN CONTEXT

21. Edit: I cant find Mias bag.

22. Edit: The dogs bone wasnt there.

23. Write one contraction sentence and one possessive-noun sentence.

E. EXPLAIN, CHECK AND EDIT

24. Explain the two jobs of apostrophes on this worksheet.

25. Why does cats mean more than one cat but cat's means belonging to one cat?

EXIT TICKET + CHALLENGE

26. Add apostrophes: Im sure Bens bike isnt here.

Challenge: Write four contraction/possessive pairs and explain each apostrophe.

F. STUDENT REVIEW - SHOW WHAT YOU UNDERSTAND

Use your own words so your teacher can see what you understand and what to practise next.

27. Explain one strategy you used today.

28. Check one answer in a different way.

29. Circle one: I understand it | I need more practice | I need help

30. The easiest part was: _____

31. The most difficult part was: _____

Why was it difficult? _____

32. My next practice step is: _____

TEACHER COPY - ANSWERS AND SUPPORT

ANSWER KEY

- A. 1) can't. 2) I'm. 3) Mia's. 4) cat's.
- B. 5) we're. 6) they'll. 7) didn't. 8) she's. 9) Ben's book. 10) bird's nest. 11) dog's. 12) can't.
- C. 13) you're. 14) it's. 15) wasn't. 16) won't. 17) teacher's desk. 18) baby's toy. 19-20) Answers vary.
- D. 21) I can't find Mia's bag. 22) The dog's bone wasn't there. 23) Answers vary.
- E. 24) Replaces letters in contractions; shows ownership in possessives. 25) No apostrophe marks plural; apostrophe+s marks possession. EXIT. 26) I'm sure Ben's bike isn't here.
- Challenge: Answers vary. Check that the student's example follows every condition and that the reasoning is mathematically correct.
- F. 27-28) Answers vary. Look for a clear strategy and a valid second check. 29-32) Use the reflection to identify confidence, difficulty and the next teaching step.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Apostrophes do not make ordinary plurals. Ask whether letters are missing or ownership is shown before adding one.

TEACHER CHECK

- ☐ Uses an appropriate Grade 1 strategy.
- ☐ Shows or explains thinking clearly.
- ☐ Checks an answer using a second representation or related fact.
- ☐ Identifies a specific difficulty and useful next practice step.

PARENT / TEACHER TIP

Ask the child to explain how they know, not only state an answer. If the explanation is unclear, use small objects, a drawing, or a number line before returning to symbols.

NEXT STEP

Revisit the item the child marked difficult. Model one example, solve one together, then ask the child to complete one independently and explain the strategy.